Rails maps columns with Decimals with no decimal places to `Integer` objects; otherwise, it maps them to `BigDecimal` objects, ensuring that no precision is lost.

In the case of Boolean, a convenience method is provided with a question mark appended to the column name:

```
user = User.find_by(name: "Dave")
if user.superuser?
  grant_privileges
end
```

In addition to the attributes we define, there are a number of attributes that either Rails provides automatically or have special meaning.

Additional Columns Provided by Active Record

A number of column names have special significance to Active Record. Here's a summary:

created_at, created_on, updated_at, updated_on
: These are automatically updated with the timestamp of a row's creation or last update. Make sure the underlying database column is capable of receiving a date, datetime, or string. Rails applications conventionally use the `_on` suffix for date columns and the `_at` suffix for columns that include a time.

id
: This is the default name of a table's primary key column (in *Identifying Individual Rows*).

xxx_id
: This is the default name of a foreign key reference to a table named with the plural form of ***xxx***.

xxx_count
: This maintains a counter cache for the child table `xxx`.

Additional plugins, such as `acts_as_list`,[98] may define additional columns.